

>> personalize your exercise

Your 15-minute Calorie Burn Workout is hopefully just a start. Read on if you want to burn calories even faster or to learn how to tone things down if you're out of condition or are having an off-day. My tips show the way and—even better—they can be applied to almost any exercise.

If you're going to the trouble of taking 15 minutes out of your day to follow my workouts, then it makes sense to try to maximize your results. It's natural to ask how you can burn even more calories in 15 minutes, especially if you find it hard to resist the occasional sweet treat the rest of the time. Also, as you progress with your exercise, you may discover that you reach a "plateau" (see p.101). This is because your body cleverly adjusts to your level of work and decides to take a vacation. You need to give it a wake-up call from time to time.

You'll be glad to know that there are plenty of ways of intensifying your exercise, both to burn more calories in the time available and to get yourself off the "plateau."

Flawless form

Firstly, remind yourself to work with flawless form all the time. That means holding your tummy in, keeping your back straight, and keeping your shoulders relaxed. It's not as easy as it sounds, and it's precisely for that reason that you'll burn more calories. Think of the effort it takes just to keep your tummy in. That effort translates into more calories burned. Not only that, but working your muscles harder means that they become sleek and toned that much faster.

Practicing a technique descriptively titled "mind to muscle" will help you work with flawless form. Simply focus on the area you want to feel working, and try to channel your muscle tension and effort on that area. At the same time make a conscious

effort to relax any other part of your body you feel is trying to "join in." This may sound very simple, but if you master this technique you are without a doubt going to get a lot more out of your training.

Maximize your moves

Next, it pays to put all you've got into each move. When you're marching, lift your knees high and really swing your arms. If you're jogging, pick your

>> taking it down a notch

- **Go from high-impact to low-impact.** If you're doing the Jog (pp.134, 146), bring it down to the level of the March (pp.130, 146). If you're doing the Skip (p.112), do the March.
- **Omit the hops and jumps.** If you're getting out of breath, simply take a step instead of doing a hop or a jump.
- **Bring your arms down.** Raising your hands above your head increases your heart rate, so if it's getting too much, take them down and concentrate on maintaining good form and the footwork.
- **Do your cool down stretches on the floor.** If you're exhausted at the end of a workout, don't skip your cool down, but stretch on the floor instead.